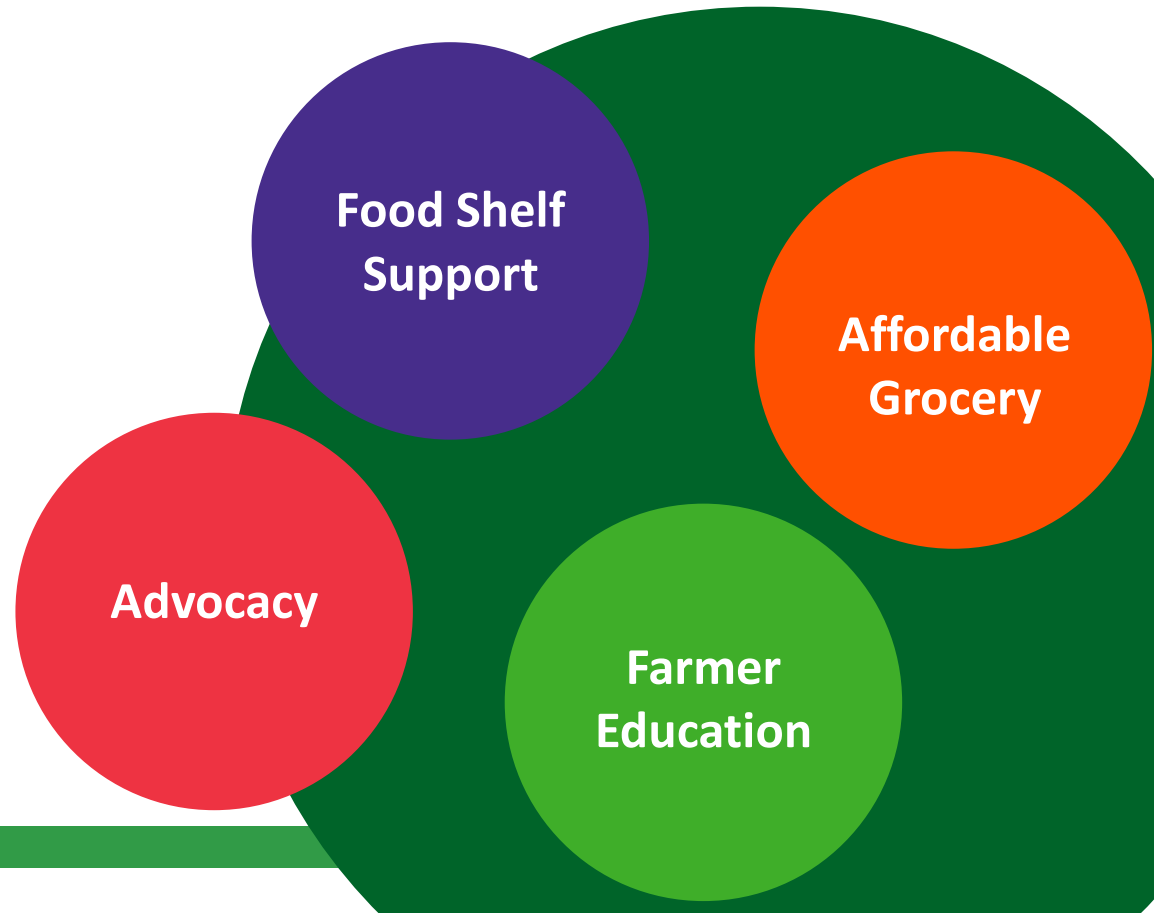


The Food Group

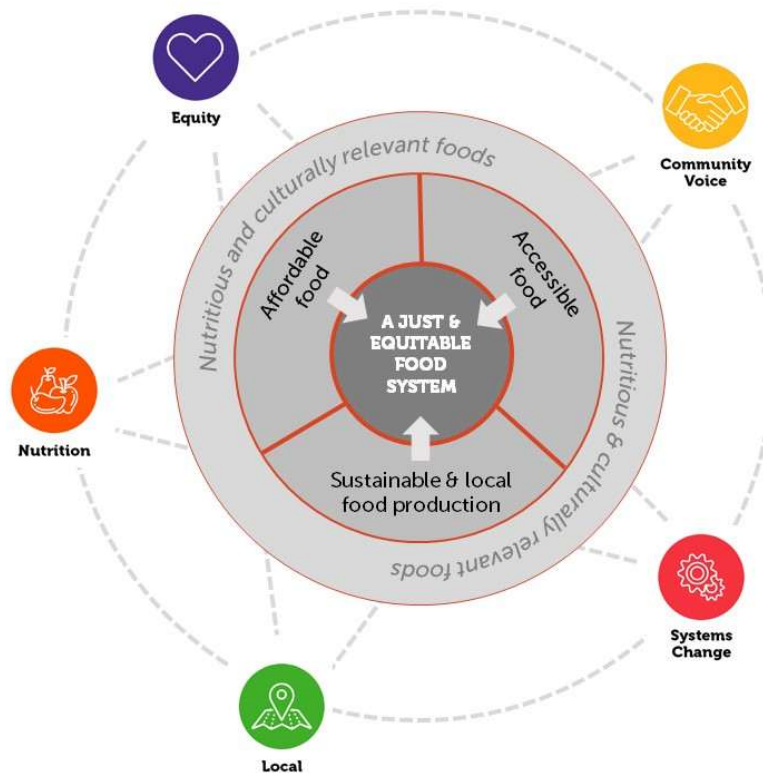
Food for today. Change for tomorrow.

The Food Group is a local food access nonprofit. For **50 years**, we have been providing quality, fresh, and culturally connected food statewide.

Our work against hunger is centered on building a better food system through access, equity, and nutrition.



Our Vision & Values



By the Numbers (2025)



50
Years

The Food Group
has been a
leader



500+
Partners

Receive food
and support
from The Food
Group



6,334,070
Meals

Provided to
neighbors who
need it most



25
Farm Teams

Growing Food at
Big River Farms and
AgriSolar



15,456
HelpLine Calls

Connecting
individuals to food
resources



Fractures in our Local Food System



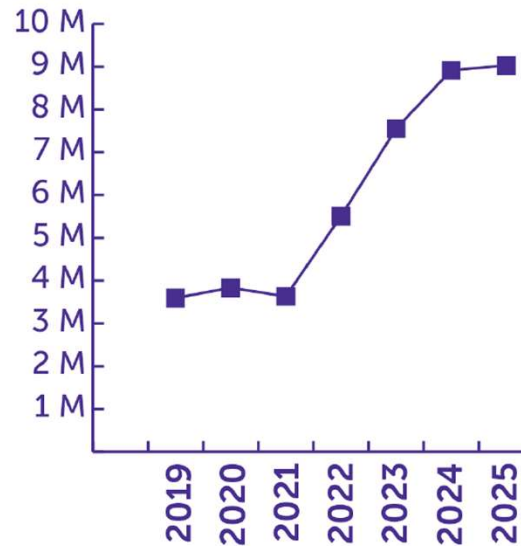
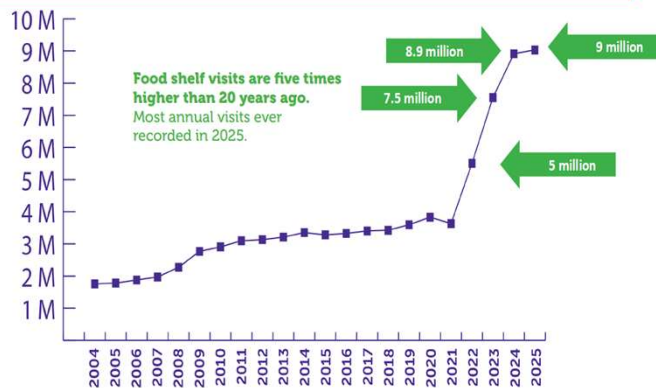
Our Work Across the Food System



Hunger Trends: 2025

Minnesotans Made 9,026,842 Visits to Food Shelves in 2025

Fourth consecutive year of shattering record number of visits.



Minnesotans made over **9 million** visits to food shelves in 2025

2.5x more than 2019

Food shelf data is collected by The Food Group in partnership with the Minnesota Department of Children, Youth, and Family.



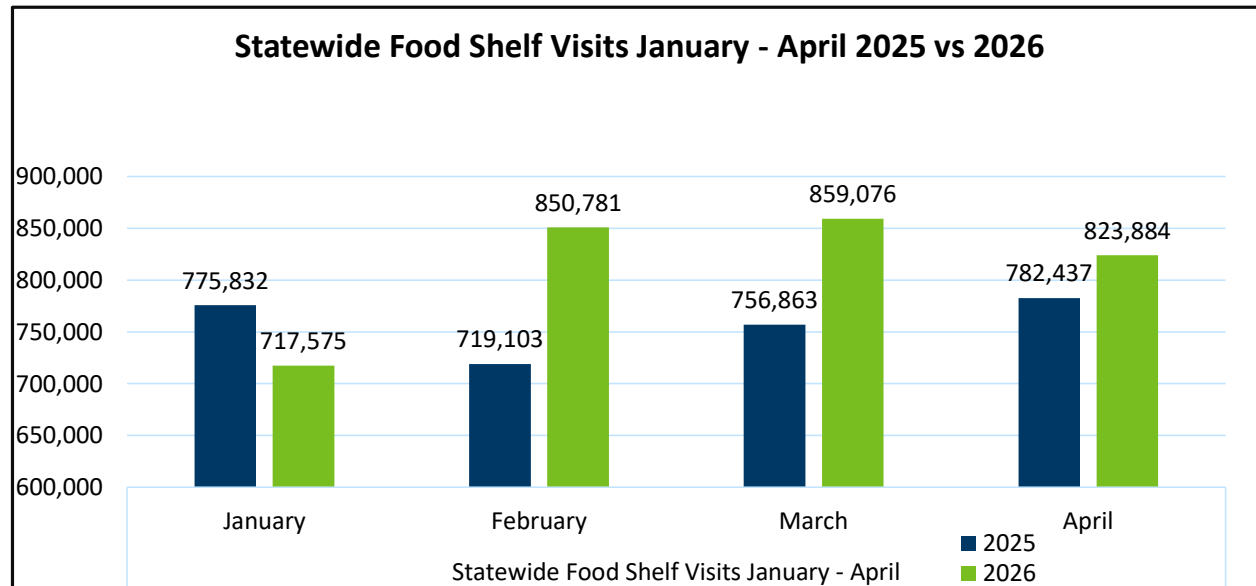
Recent Food Shelf Visit Trends in 2026

Trend #1: Visits Drop in January

Trend #2: Visits Climb Sharply in February – April

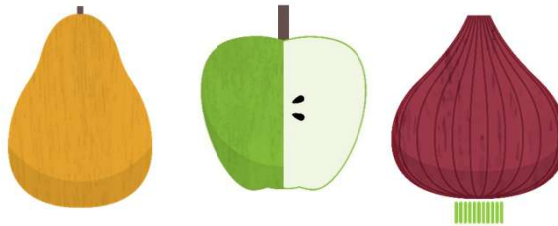
February – April 2026 vs Last Year

- Total statewide food shelf visits in February to April were **up 12%** compared to last year.
- There were **859,076 visits** to food shelves in March, the **most ever recorded** in a month.
- There were **850,781 visits** to food shelves in February, **the second most ever recorded** in a month.



Current Landscape

- Rapid Responses Needed
 - Federal Uncertainty & Policy Changes
 - SNAP Cuts and Delays
 - Immigrant Food Access during Operation Metro Surge
- Rising Costs of Food & Gas



The Food Group in the News

1. [Grocery inflation is hitting Minnesota food shelves and their recipients](#)

We spoke with Star Tribune about the double burden of record food shelf demand and high prices for food and supplies due to inflation and the Iran War. Many food shelves are making tough choices about the foods they purchase and food banks like The Food Group are contending with rising fuel cost.

2. [Almanac | Five Years of Increased Food Insecurity | Season 2026 | Episode 39 | PBS](#)

We sat down with TPT Almanac to talk about the spike in food shelf visits this spring. SNAP cuts and high costs are putting pressure on families across Minnesota in urban, suburban, and rural communities alike—and straining our hunger relief system.

3. [Food shelf demand sets new records in Minnesota | MPR News](#)

With 2026 set to be the fifth year in a row the number of food shelf visits broke an annual record, we sat down with All Things Considered at MPR News to talk about the growing need for food assistance in 2026.

4. [As federal immigration surge eases, demand at food shelves still at record level](#)

We sat down with The Star Tribune to talk about what's happening with hunger relief in the wake of Operation Metro Surge, how food shelf visits surged in the past three months, and what's driving need from rising gas prices to the SNAP cuts that have left 16,000 Minnesotans without their benefits already in 2026.



Looking Ahead – Data as a Tool

- Rapidly changing landscape requires data to drive investments
- Nonprofits often don't invest heavily in data science
- Your work plays a **CRITICAL** role in our future ability to meet community need
- **THANK YOU!**

